

René Gaudoin, PhD

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Personal Profile

- **Objective:** Building innovative solutions that push technical boundaries — exploring healthcare, science, fine wine, and beyond.
- **Strength:** Finding and implementing novel solutions based on diverse experience in academia and analytics consulting; driven by curiosity.
- **Academic background:** Research in computational science (solid state physics, quantum chemistry, public health, theoretical neurobiology).
- **Non-academic background:** DS/ML at QuantumBlack/McKinsey; online advertising; currently at StratosX.
- **Wine expertise:** Special prize at follow-up exam for all UK [WSET](#) 3 graduates with 100% score in 2016.
- **Highlights:** Deep Reinforcement Learning ([America's Cup 2021](#), DataIQ Grand Prix), survival analysis and real world evidence on longitudinal medical data, deep neural network analysis of 1d medical data, randomised control trial simulation.

Professional Experience and Achievements

- **Machine learning and statistical methods:** Reinforcement learning (supply chain optimisation, logistics, sailing); health care (public health, HES, real world evidence, randomised control trial simulations, drug discovery, marketing), LLMs (LangChain, agentic workflows, prompt engineering); deep learning & DL surrogates, supervised/unsupervised tech stack (including causal modelling/inference; Bayesian stats etc.).
- **Developing new algorithms:** Calibration of statistical data, exact sampling for Quantum Monte Carlo, extending the Perceptron algorithm to time series of realistic neurons, modelling with aggregated target variable, and more.
- **Computational science:** Ab initio methods (DFT, post-HF, QMC) and their theoretical foundations, theoretical neurobiology, basic computational fluid dynamics.
- **Tech stack:** *Languages:* Python, C, Fortran, Scala, some R, SQL. *ML/Data:* TensorFlow, Ray/RLlib, Stable-Baselines, pandas, scikit-learn, scipy, statsmodels, seaborn, matplotlib. *Infrastructure:* Git, Linux, Jupyter, AWS, Databricks, Spark, Ray, Jira. *Other:* $\LaTeX$.
- **AI-assisted development:** Productive use of AI pair programming (Claude Code) with traditional engineering discipline — not vibe coding; also an equaliser for technical minds in written communication.

Employment and Work Experience

CAIO, StratosX, London 2.2025–present
Chief AI Officer at airline disruption recovery startup. Defining, implementing, and validating ML applications across the platform.

Independent research, London/Munich 10.2024–2.2025
Time out for family; independent exploration of ideas and emerging technologies.

Data Scientist, QuantumBlack (McKinsey), London 5.2017–9.2024
End-to-end ML solutions from ideation to production code handover.

Selected projects:

- America's Cup 2021 (Team NZ): deep RL for boat design — DataIQ Grand Prix winner
- Major European pharma corporation: marketing optimisation with novel algorithm for misaligned units of analysis — assetised internally

- Major pharma corporation: real-world evidence study with survival modelling for heart failure
- Major UK university (R&D collaboration): ML/deep learning analysis of clinical haematology sensor data
- Major metals company: deep RL for order processing
- European generics manufacturer: market share optimisation

Other areas: LLM prototyping (LangChain agents, exploring RL for autonomous web navigation), RCT simulation, IT productivity, DL surrogates, CFD.

Data Scientist, Infectious Media, London 9.2014–5.2017
Modelling click/conversion probabilities for bidding on online ads (Python/Scala/Spark)

Fellow, S2DS data science summer school, London 8.2014
Business, IT, and ML lectures followed by project work for Stratified Medical (Gensim, Neo4j).

Post-Doc (medical statistics), Imperial College (Dr. Foster Unit), London 2.2012–3.2014
Investigating ML techniques beyond logistic regression (LR) for risk assessment (SMRs) on large medical data sets (HES).

Post-Doc, University of Vienna (Computational Material Physics) 5.2010–1.2012
Applications/coding-up of DFT and Post-HF methods extending the functionality of the VASP package.

Academic Visitor, Fritz-Haber-Institut, Berlin 9.2009–3.2010
Research into post-HF methods for van-der-Waals dominated systems.

Post-Doc, Donostia International Physics Institute 11.2004–3.2009
Developing new algorithms for parallelised Quantum Monte Carlo (CASINO package), worked out the maths of and coded new algorithms, developed from scratch a new exact sampling technique.

Post-Doc, Rutgers University, NJ, USA 12.2002–9.2004
Working on the fundamentals of density functional theory I discovered that contrary to assumptions, an important ground-state theorem does not generalise to other Quantum states.

Research Assistant, Imperial College, London 1.2001–3.2002
Publishing research and finalising papers at the Condensed Matter Theory Group.

Education

PhD, Imperial College, London 10.1996–12.2000
Condensed Matter Theory Group – Quantum Monte Carlo calculations. We developed an inhomogeneous extension to trial wavefunctions implemented in the Casino package.

Diplom-Physiker, TU München 12.1988–2.1995
General Physics (Maths, Physics, some Chemistry), grade 1.6. Final year thesis in theoretical Biophysics modelling spiking neurons and developing a Perceptron for these.

Secondary school, European School 10.1980–6.1988
European Baccalaureate (top marks in economics, maths, physics, and chemistry)

Other Accomplishments

Communication: Publishing in high-impact journals, talks, posters, client visits, problem solving

Teaching: Problem based learning (PBL); tutoring undergraduates, mentoring junior colleagues

Languages: German/English – bilingual; Spanish – fluent; French – intermediate

Wine: WSET Level 3 with distinction (won Oddbins Scholarship at a special round for the best graduates).